

Kids Connection -- Draft MILS Plan

MILS Purpose:

To naturally collect information that is rich, quickly analyzed, and leads to valid lessons, conclusions, predictions, and effective actions.

OUR TOOLBOX

Sources of Data & Data Collection

1. People: staff, students, volunteers, parents/guardians, teachers, neighborhood leaders, other stakeholders
2. Archival Records: public records from school, local government, and civic organizations; meeting notes and documents / DCFS / J/MC

Tools for Data Collection

1. Direct observation/documentation / interview records
2. By-products measurement
3. Interviews
4. Self-report surveys / Aggregation & analysis

Methods of Data Collection, Entry, Analysis, & Reporting:

1. Paper-pencil
2. Scantron - software \$300 / scanner \$6K
3. Telephone
4. Photography
5. Audio recording
6. Video recording
7. Computer (software)
8. PDA - palm pilot
9. Internet

Challenges

Isolation - web/organization, facilitation, transference

LEARNING VS MANAGEMENT

MILS Agenda for Information/Outcomes to Understand & Improve

wasn't here

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
Students:		
<i>Track / analysis of current -</i>		
Recruitment		
- How do we recruit more students that would benefit from KC? - Where do we need to focus &/or improve our recruitment efforts? <i>How do we keep Veterans returning?</i>	- Student interests - Existing competing and facilitating neighborhood activities - Feedback from students and key stakeholders	- Survey &/or focus groups of area youth &/or those familiar with area youth on interests and needs - New participant survey
Maintenance		
- How long do we keep students? <i>Participation /</i>	- Amount & rate of drop-outs - Amount & rate of active students	Attendance tracking system
- How do we keep more students longer? - What factors affect/predict student retention? - Which can be influenced by us?	- Safety, comfort, conduciveness of setting for learning - Student input/participation/leadership in program decision-making - Degree to which activities are interesting/stimulating, challenging, and rewarding - Satisfaction rates	- Focus groups - Surveys - Direct observations
What are students exposed to, what are they experiencing?	Program/activity participation rates	Program/activity tracking system
- How do we better engage students in activities? <i>Current Participation</i>	- Participation rates by and across activities - Feedback from students	- Program/activity tracking system - Surveys
How well is the volunteer-student relationship working?	- Satisfaction rates - Type and quality of volunteer-	- Survey - Direct observation

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
	student interactions	
<i>Program Results</i>		
• How are students improving in Y outcome? • How does X program/activity (or as a group) contribute to youth development?	• Amount & rate of common behavior problems (substance abuse, teen parenthood, violence/injury) • Amount & rate of: – skill development (e.g., points for punctuality, goal setting, critical thinking), – school/academic achievement (e.g., grades, standardized test scores), – graduation/advancement (e.g., in school, in internships), – college/vocational achievement (e.g. number attend college, finish college, job types & job salaries)	• Baseline & periodic survey &/or direct observation via self-assessment &/or staff assessment (KC has tons of these we can refine - Student Handbook Quiz, Performance Appraisal • Tracking of daily program measures (attendance sheets, tutoring session descriptions) • Portfolio assessment • Parent/guardian, volunteer, teacher, other stakeholder questionnaire
• How well are students reaching their goals and objectives?	• Amount & rate of goal achievement	• Goal assessment tool (self &/or staff assessment) • Journey Mapping • Win-Win contracts
• How do students influence other community changes (youth leadership)?	• Advocacy/change to improve community conditions • Amount & rate of community service	• Journey Mapping • Documentation System • Surveys
• How many students become adult TM volunteers?	• Amount of alumni volunteers	• Volunteer tracking system

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
Volunteers:		
<i>Recruitment</i>		
• What works to best recruit more volunteers that would benefit KC and benefit from KC? • How many volunteers are recruiting other volunteers? • Where do we need to focus &/or improve our recruitment efforts?	• Student interests • Existing competing and facilitating neighborhood activities • Feedback from students and key stakeholders • Best practices research	• Survey &/or focus groups of area youth &/or those familiar with area youth on interests and needs • Referral tracking system • New participant survey
• How do we recruit the right volunteers for our students?	• Student and volunteer feedback • Best practices from other programs	•
• How many volunteers take on other, non-TM roles?	• Amount & rate of donations/giving • Participation/action/advocacy in their neighborhood, workplace, church, etc. on behalf of TM/youth. • Starting new TM • Helping recruit, train, develop, etc other volunteers	• Documentation System • Survey
<i>Maintenance</i>		
• How many volunteers stay for how long / X time period?	• Amount & rate of volunteer sustainability	• Volunteer tracking system
• What are volunteer exposed to, what are they experiencing?	• Program/Activity participation rates	• Program/Activity tracking system
• What factors affect/predict volunteer retention? • Which can be influenced by us?	• Volunteer input/participation/leadership in program decision-making	• Surveys • Focus groups • Intervention research
• How many volunteers are competent in X TM skill?	• Rate of passing volunteer self-assessments Student ratings of	• Survey • Direct observation

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
	volunteer performance	• Training evaluation surveys
• What factors affect volunteer development?	• Feedback form satisfaction surveys • Volunteer input/participation/leadership in program decision-making	• Satisfaction/Outcomes Survey • Volunteer-student acquaintance survey (e.g., "Getting Started...")
• How do we develop better and better volunteer TMs?	• Volunteer, student and other stakeholder feedback	• Evaluation of TM Handbook effectiveness? • Staff and outside stakeholder critique/review • Survey • Direct observation
<i>Program Results</i>		
• How are volunteers improving in Y outcome? • How does X program/activity (or as a group) contribute to volunteer development?	• Amount & rate of common behavior student problems (substance abuse, teen parenthood, violence/injury) • Amount & rate of student: – skill development (e.g., points for punctuality, goal setting, critical thinking), – school/academic achievement (e.g., grades, standardized test scores), – graduation/advancement (e.g., in school, in internships), – college/vocational achievement (e.g. number attend college, finish college, job types & job salaries) • Amount & rate of volunteer	• Baseline & periodic survey &/or direct observation via self-assessment &/or staff assessment (KC has tons of these we can refine - Student Handbook Quiz, Performance Appraisal • Tracking of daily program measures (attendance sheets, tutoring session descriptions) • Portfolio assessment (add volunteer portfolio) • Parent/guardian, volunteer, teacher, other stakeholder questionnaire

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
	outcomes (job, family, life results; volunteer personal development)	
• How well are volunteers reaching their goals and objectives?	• Amount & rate of goal achievement	• Goal assessment tool (self &/or staff assessment) • Journey Mapping • Win-Win contracts

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
Program/Activity:		
<i>Development</i>		
What new programs/activities and modifications are needed?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique	- Surveys - Staff review of program results - Documentation System
What are best practices in program/activity development?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique	- Program Checklist (safety, developmental activities, etc.) - Documentation System - Best practices review
Is X program/activity implemented as it needs to be (successfully)?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique	Direct observations using program implementation checklist
How could we implement X better?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique - Satisfaction ratings of X	Surveys: Book Survey, Website Survey, etc
<i>Maintenance</i>		
How do we decide what program should be kept, deleted, or modified?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique - Satisfaction ratings of X	- Program Checklist (safety, developmental activities, etc.) - Documentation System - Best practices review
Are volunteers/staff trained well enough / prepared enough to adequately implement activity?	- Student and volunteer feedback - Staff feedback	- Volunteer performance checklists - Staff performance checklists

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
<i>Program Results</i>		
How effective is X program/activity for improving Y outcome?	SEE STUDENT & VOLUNTEER SECTIONS	
How can it be more effective?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique - Satisfaction ratings of X	- Surveys - Staff review of program results - Documentation System
What factors affect/predict program/activity success?	- Feedback from students, volunteers, and stakeholders - Program critique - Satisfaction ratings of X	Checklists, tracking systems, and outcomes assessments
What is the distribution of X type of program across Y outcome (e.g., student or volunteer outcome, types of curriculum - social, academic, career, etc.)?	Amount and distribution of outcomes across predefined categories.	Documentation System, other tracking systems and outcome assessments

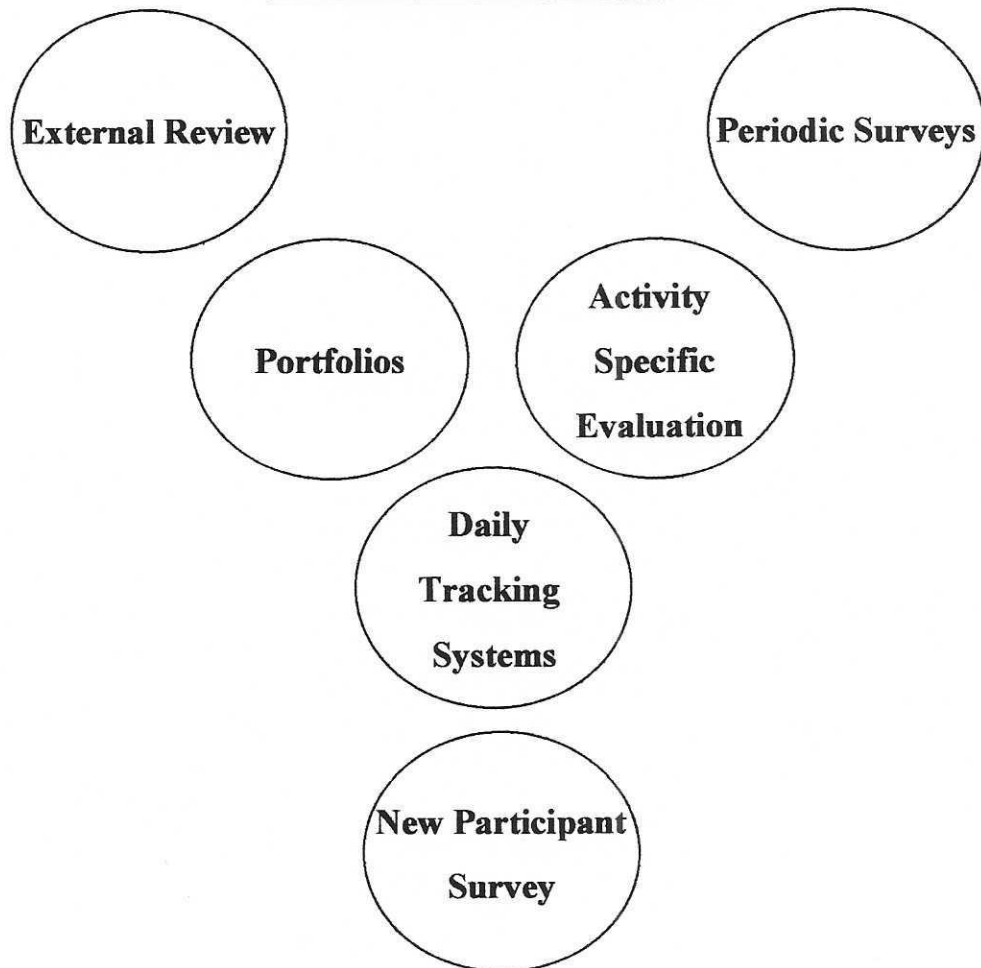
Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
Organizations:		
<i>Recruitment</i>		
How is X organization contributing to our recruitment for Y program, area, etc?	Distribution of volunteer and student outcomes of different organizations over time	- SEE SHERIDAN'S WORK - Documentation System
- What factors effect/predict recruitment from any given organization? - How can we increase, improve this?	- Feedback from volunteers and leaders of organizations and other stakeholders - CEO satisfaction ratings of our value to their business/organizations	- Documentation System - Surveys - Focus groups - Intervention research
How is X activity/program/etc. of value to Y organization?		
How many volunteers are coming from area organizations (businesses, etc)		
<i>Maintenance</i>		
How do we maintain and increase support from any given organization?		
- What factors effect/predict sustaining our relationship with any given organization? - How can we increase, improve this?		
<i>Program Results</i>		
How is our work impacting X organization in Y sector?		
How is X activity/program/etc. of value		

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
to Y organization?		
• How is X organization impacting our outcomes for Y objective?	•	•
• How is the distribution of our efforts (e.g., activities, events, time, etc) related to the distribution of outcomes (e.g., volunteer and student outcomes, resources, donations) for different organizations or types of business?	•	•
• What factors effect/predict our effectiveness toward organizational outcomes? • How can we increase, improve this?	•	•

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
	Community Broadly	
	<i>Recruitment</i>	
SEE ORGANIZATIONAL SECTION		
	<i>Maintenance</i>	
	<i>Program Results</i>	
SEE VOLUNTEER & STUDENT SECTIONS		
How are we achieving our objectives?	see Demo Table	Documentation System
How are we distributing our efforts across X sector, Y strategy, etc?	see Demo Graphs	Documentation System
How are we influencing our immediate/surrounding neighborhood?	Student, volunteer, organizational outcomes by zip code or neighborhood	Survey, tracking system results
How is the distribution of our efforts (e.g., activities, events, time, etc) related to the distribution of outcomes (e.g., volunteer and student outcomes, resources, donations) for different community sectors, organizations, neighborhoods, etc.?		Documentation System Volunteer and student tracking systems Outcomes measurement systems
- What factors effect/predict our effectiveness toward organizational outcomes? - How can we increase, improve this?		

Examples of Questions by Unit of Analysis	Examples of Information/Outcome	Examples of MILS Tool/Method
Staff:		
<i>Recruitment</i>		
- How do we recruit the best staff for our needs and objectives? - What are our criteria?	•	•
•	•	•
<i>Maintenance</i>		
How do we better prevent staff turnover?	•	•
How do we better develop our staff?	•	•
How do we work better as a team?	•	•
Are staff trained well enough / prepared enough to adequately implement programs/activities?	•	•
<i>Program Results</i>		
How well are staff reaching their goals and objectives?	•	- Goal assessment tool (self &/or staff assessment) - Journey Mapping - Win-Win contracts - Documentation System
What skills, competencies and strengths of any given staff member can be used more effectively?	• •	• •
• What skills, competencies and strengths of any given staff member can be taught to other staff and other TM organizations?	• •	• •

MILS Components



Some MILS Challenges & Potential Solutions

Not useful	• Prioritize what is most important/useful regarding evaluation • Unique ID#s for students, volunteers, programs/activities, organizations, and other key variables of analysis • Use software for data entry that permits flexible analysis (no Excel) • Measure 1 or 2 common outcomes across program/activity (participation rate; satisfaction; usefulness) • Periodically evaluate/review usefulness of evaluation/MILS tools
No enough time	• Prioritize what is most important/useful regarding evaluation • Use software for data entry that permits flexible analysis (no Excel) • Choose people best positioned to naturally collect, enter, etc. with data • Fit data collection into naturally occurring opportunities and program function (e.g., the daily program description forms) • Increase the number of people that collect, enter, etc. work with data • Increase "other's" ability to collect, enter, etc. work with data • Increase investment (\$ and in-kind support) in external MILS support
Too difficult	• Prioritize what is most important/useful regarding evaluation • Use software for data entry that permits flexible analysis (no Excel) • Improve our MILS competencies and abilities • Increase investment (\$ and in-kind support) in external MILS support

Priorities & Timeline

MILS DRAFT, 8/3/00, Kids Connection

Run through specific examples for attendance

Run through specific example for student data (connecting it with volunteer info, program/activity info, etc)

Attendance, program description, satisfaction surveys, periodic self/staff assessment, new volunteer and student application, maybe add intro interview

Self, staff, students, volunteer, outside staff

Situations when web/no web data entry, analysis, report prep, etc.